

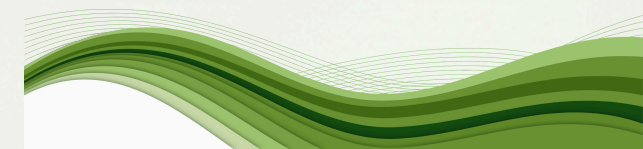
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Reducing Missed Appointments in a Telemedicine Platform

A Focused Product Intervention to Improve
Completed Consultations

CAPSTONE PROJECT FOR WINTER CONSULTING '2025

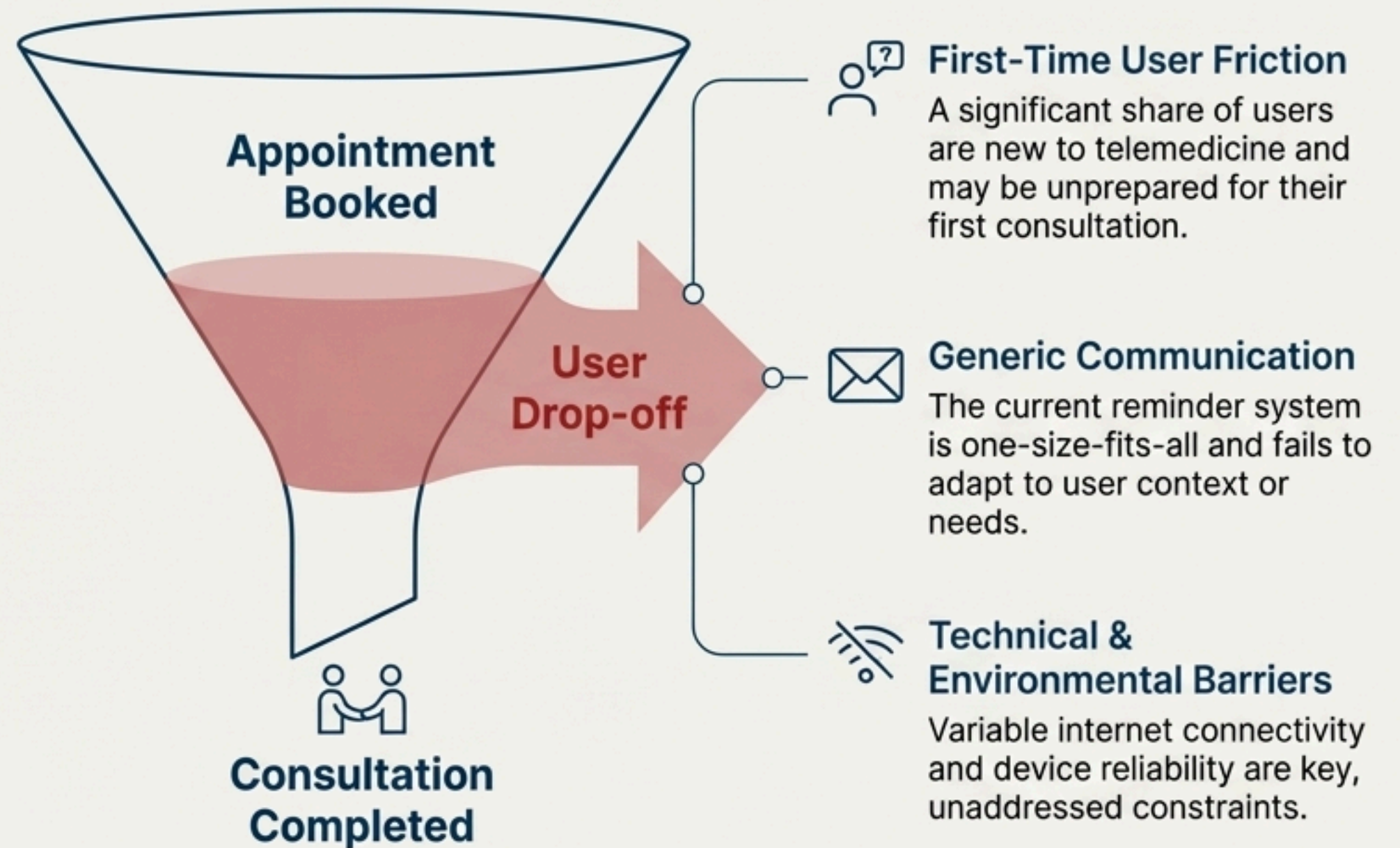


A “Leaky Funnel” Between Booking and Joining Drives Missed Appointments

The Business Impact

- A high incidence of missed or late appointments creates a cascade of negative effects:
 - **Operational Inefficiency:** Idle and underutilized doctor time.
 - **Eroding Trust:** Reduced doctor confidence in the platform's reliability, leading to lower retention.
 - **Increased Overhead:** Higher customer support volume for rescheduling and complaints.
 - **Financial Strain:** Pressure on overall unit economics and reduced platform credibility.

The Root Causes



Our Hypothesis: Proactive Guidance and Adaptive Communication Will Convert More Bookings to Completions

By reducing onboarding friction for first-time users and implementing an adaptive reminder system, we can significantly **increase the percentage of patients who are prepared and on-time** for their scheduled consultation.



1. GUIDE

Proactively prepare first-time users with a simple, in-app checklist immediately after booking to ensure they are technically ready.



2. ADAPT

Evolve from static reminders to an intelligent system that tailors messaging based on user type and connectivity signals.



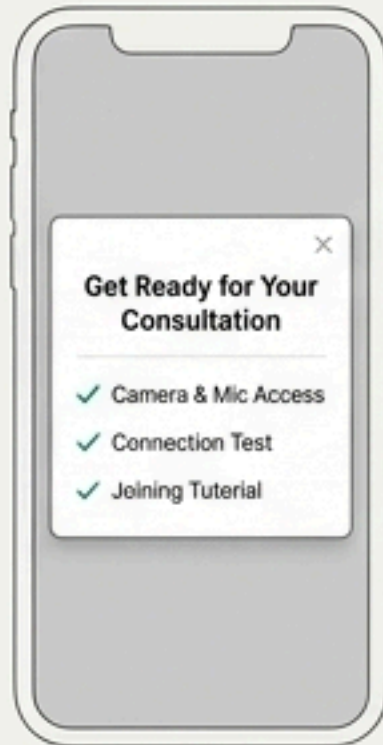
3. REASSURE

Manage the doctor's experience of waiting to reduce frustration and improve their confidence in the platform.

This approach aligns with all project constraints: it requires **no major infrastructure changes** and focuses on **improving existing flows** and **introducing small, targeted product enhancements**.

The Solution: A Three-Part Intervention We Call “Smart Start”

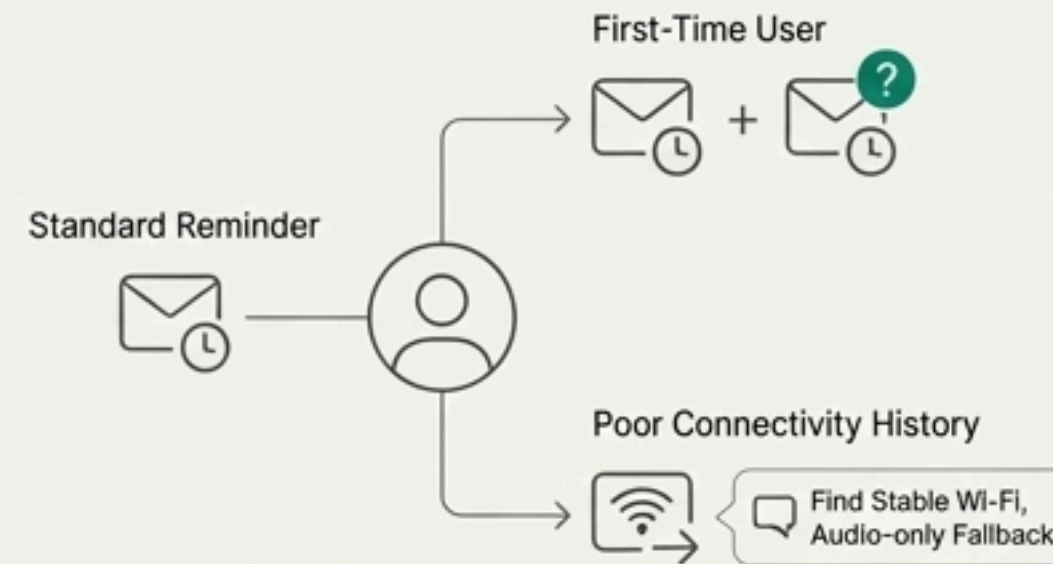
The “Quick Onboarding” Checklist



What it is: A one-time, skippable modal for first-time users, triggered immediately after booking.

Purpose: Guides the user through a <60-second readiness check for: Device Permissions (camera/microphone access), a quick connectivity test, and a brief tutorial on how to join the call.

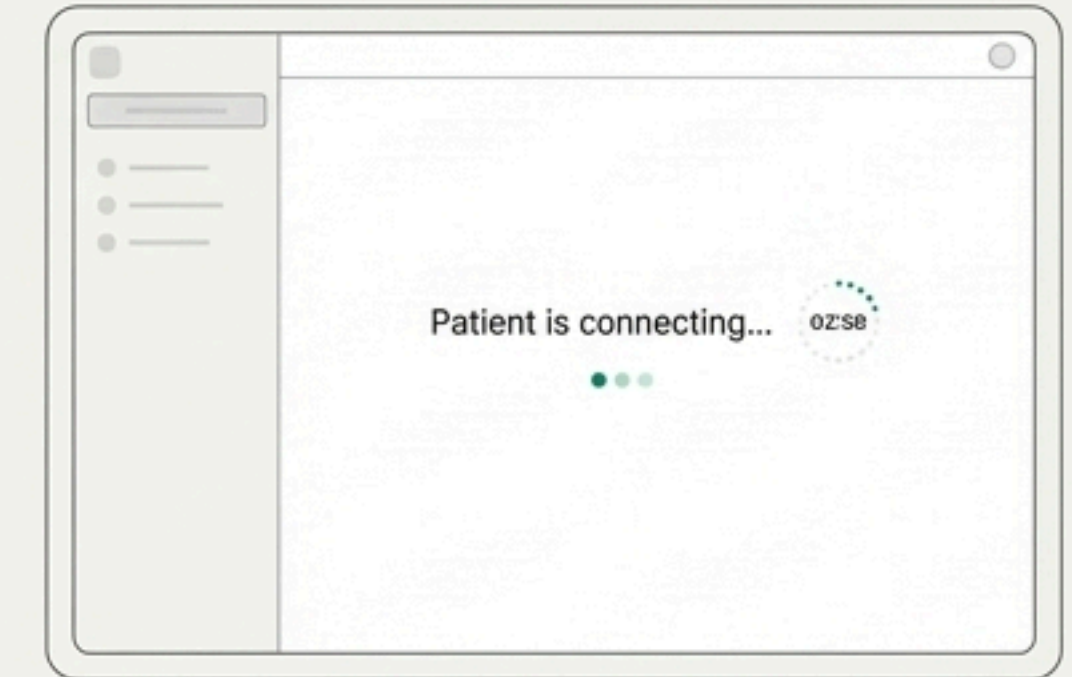
Adaptive Reminder Flow



What it is: A parameterized notification system that changes cadence and content based on user signals.

Examples: First-Time User receives an extra reminder with a link to a help guide. User with Poor Connectivity History reminder suggests finding a stable Wi-Fi connection and highlights the audio-only fallback option.

Doctor “Soft-Hold” Interface



What it is: A UI update for the doctor's view when a patient is late.

Purpose: Replaces a static “Waiting for patient” message with a more reassuring “Patient is connecting...” status and a 3-minute buffer, reducing perceived idle time and doctor frustration.

“Smart Start” Offers the Highest Impact with the Lowest User Friction

Alternatives Considered & Rejected



Financial Penalties / Deposits

Creates high user friction, damages platform trust, and fails to solve the underlying technical and preparedness issues.



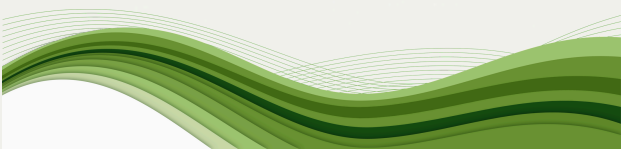
Overbooking Doctor Schedules

Poses a significant risk to patient experience (creating long waits) and erodes doctor confidence in their schedules.

Prioritization using the RICE Framework

RICE Framework Score: “Smart Start”		
Criteria	Score	Justification
Reach	High	Affects all first-time users and others experiencing connectivity issues.
Impact	High	Directly addresses the primary drivers of missed appointments.
Confidence	Medium-High	Based on established patterns for improving user onboarding and engagement.
Effort	Low-Medium	Leverages existing UI (modals, notifications) with no major backend overhaul.

The high RICE score confirms this is the most logical and efficient initiative to pursue.



Success Will Be Measured by a 20% Drop in Misses, with Risks Actively Mitigated

Measuring Success

20%

% of Missed Appointments: (Appointments not joined) / (Total scheduled appointments)

Target: A 20% relative reduction within 8 weeks of full rollout.



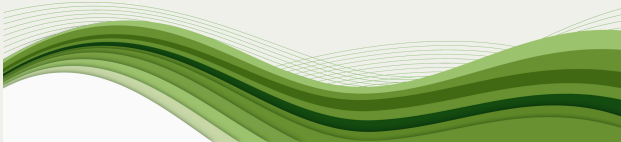
Doctor Utilization: An increase in the % of booked slots successfully completed.



Support Ticket Volume: A reduction in tickets related to rescheduling and call-joining issues.

Key Risks & Mitigation Plan

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
User Apathy: Users ignore the new checklist and reminders.	Design compelling CTAs, make the checklist skippable after first use, and utilize SMS as a fallback for critical reminders.
Added Friction: The checklist could deter some users during booking.	A/B test the intervention, ensure the flow is <60 seconds, and clearly communicate the benefit: "Ensure a smooth consultation."
False Confidence: The connectivity check is positive, but the user's connection degrades later.	Include a disclaimer in the check, add a suggestion in the final reminder to join from a stable connection, and promote the audio-only fallback option.



Appendix: Implementation Plan & Requirements

Phased 6-Week Rollout Timeline

Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5	Week 6
Design & Prototyping (UX/UI for all new components)		Development & QA (FE/BE bulld and testing)			
	Pilot Launch (Release to 10% of new users to monitor initial impact)				
			Full Rollout & Measurement begin 8-week measurement period)	Rollot (Release to 100% and begin 8-week measurement period)	

Data & Resource Needs

Data Required for Baseline Analysis

- Current missed appointment rate (segmented by new vs. returning users).
- Distribution of user joining latency.
- Categorized support ticket counts.

Estimated Resource Allocation

- **Product:** 1 PM
- **Design:** 1 Product Designer (part-time)
- **Engineering:** 1 Frontend Developer, 1 Backend Developer
- **QA:** 1 QA Engineer (part-time)

